SLA REVIEW QUESTIONS 1–40 WITH ANSWERS

Question 1

Acquisition and instruction of pragmatics involve ALL except...

A. Socially appropriate language use

B. Pragmalinguistic features i.e. linguistic means for communication

C. Social issues such as gender equity

D. Sociopragmatic features (e.g. when and how to use certain expressions)

Answer: C. Social issues such as gender equity

Question 2

Interlanguage refers to the random and inconsistent language use by L2 learners.

A. True

B. False

Answer: False

Question 3

What is a key advantage of output-prompting feedback like elicitation?

A. It provides the correct form directly

B. It avoids learner errors entirely

C. It eliminates the need for noticing

D. It engages learners in deeper cognitive processing

Answer: D. It engages learners in deeper cognitive processing

Question 4

What is a common method used to assess pragmatic competence?

A. Multiple-choice grammar tests

B. Translation exercises

C. Discourse completion tasks

D. Listening comprehension tests

Answer: C. Discourse completion tasks

Question 5

Which task type is most likely to promote negotiation of meaning?

A. Two-way information gap with convergent goals

B. One-way information gap with divergent goals

C. Memorization-based tasks

D. Grammar translation tasks

Answer: A. Two-way information gap with convergent goals

Question 6

Match the features and types of knowledge.

1. accessible for spontaneous communication
2. metalinguistic awareness
3. used for monitoring language performance
4. incidentally acquired

Answer: 1 implicit; 2 explicit; 3 explicit; 4 implicit knowledge

Question 7

Which statement is false?

A. Pronunciation is learnable and guided practice and awareness can reshape habits.

B. Awareness and feedback do not make any change in pronunciation.

C. Intelligibility rather than native-like accent is the target of instruction.

D. An integrated instructional approach is best for pronunciation instruction.

Answer: B. Awareness and feedback do not make any change in pronunciation.

Question 8

Which factor most enhances pragmatic development in L2 learners?

A. Reading grammar books

B. Studying phonetics

C. Learning isolated vocabulary

D. Exposure to authentic language use

Answer: D. Exposure to authentic language use

Question 9

The role of Second Language Acquisition research is .....

A. to understand how learners can be taught.

B. to inform linguists of how learners develop language.

C. to tell stories of successful learners.

D. to inform understanding of the second language learning process and how it can be facilitated or hindered.

Answer: D. to inform understanding of the second language learning process and how it can be facilitated or hindered.

Question 10

Which statement is False about Second Language Acquisition?

A. SLA involves the study of how L2 instruction can impact the L2 implicit knowledge.

B. SLA studies the L2 learner's development of different aspects of L2 knowledge.

C. One of the fundamental questions of SLA is the nature of knowledge that L2 learners develop.

D. SLA focuses on the acquisition of a second language recognized as an official language by a government.

Answer: D. SLA focuses on the acquisition of a second language recognized as an official language by a government.

Question 11

Tick all factors influencing how pragmatics is acquired.

A. Assessment

B. Learners' age

C. Learning environment

D. Learning motivation

E. Learner proficiency level

Answer: B, C, D, E: Learners' age; learning environment; learning motivation; learner proficiency level

Question 12

Match the individual factors and their characteristics.

1. working memory
2. Learning strategies
3. language learning aptitude
4. willingness to communicate
5. emotion
6. Learning styles

Answer: working memory—stable trait; learning strategies—dynamic and changing; aptitude—stable trait; willingness to communicate—dynamic and changing; emotion—dynamic and changing; learning styles—stable trait

Question 13

Second Language Acquisition not only presents explanations about how L2 is learned, but also researches the role of L2 instruction in the acquisition process.

A. True

B. False

Answer: True

Question 14

According to the Teachability Hypothesis, what determines when a learner can acquire a grammatical structure?

A. The learner's motivation level

B. The number of times the structure is practiced

C. The complexity of the structure

D. The learner's developmental readiness

Answer: D. The learner's developmental readiness

Question 15

Match the information.

1. Support provided to help learners perform beyond their current ability
2. Learners transform social interactions into internal cognitive processes
3. Use of tools (e.g., language, peers, technology) to aid learning

Answer: 1 scaffolding; 2 internalization; 3 mediation

Question 16

What does Swain's Comprehensible Output Hypothesis argue?

A. Output is unnecessary for language learning

B. Output helps learners process morphosyntactic elements and test hypotheses

C. Learners should only focus on semantic meaning

D. Grammar instruction should precede output activities

Answer: B. Output helps learners process morphosyntactic elements and test hypotheses

Question 17

Instructed Second Language Acquisition is a theoretically and empirically based field of academic inquiry that aims to understand how the systematic manipulation of the mechanisms of learning and/or the ..... under which they occur enable or facilitate the development and acquisition of an additional language (Lowen, 2020, p.3)

Answer: conditions

Question 18

What are the theoretical foundations for instructed second language acquisition?

A. Skill Acquisition Theory

B. Interaction theory

C. Universal Grammar

D. Input Processing Theory

E. Sociocultural Theory

Answer: A, B, D, E: Skill Acquisition Theory; Interaction theory; Input Processing Theory; Sociocultural Theory

Question 19

Which best reflects a key fact about grammar acquisition in second language learning?

A. Grammar acquisition occurs in a fixed order that can be changed through instruction.

B. Explicit instruction always leads to immediate and accurate grammar use in communication.

C. Learners acquire grammatical structures in a natural developmental sequence, regardless of instruction.

D. Learners can acquire any grammar rule if it is taught clearly and repeatedly.

Answer: C. Learners acquire grammatical structures in a natural developmental sequence, regardless of instruction.

Question 20

What factors influence the quality of interaction in the classroom?

A. Learners' traits such as mindset and attitude towards collaboration

B. Learners' background

C. Learners' proficiency levels

D. Context of interaction

E. Learners' use of L1 during interaction

Answer: A, C, D, E: learners' traits; learners' proficiency levels; context of interaction; learners' use of L1

Question 21

Which of the following best distinguishes Long's Interaction Theory from Sociocultural Theory in second language acquisition?

A. Sociocultural Theory views learning as individual discovery, while Long's theory promotes teacher-led instruction

B. Long's theory centers on negotiation for meaning during interaction, while Sociocultural Theory emphasizes mediated learning through social collaboration

C. Long's theory emphasizes social context, while Sociocultural Theory focuses on internal cognitive processes

D. Both theories reject the role of social interaction in language learning

Answer: B. Long's theory centers on negotiation for meaning during interaction, while Sociocultural Theory emphasizes mediated learning through social collaboration

Question 22

What is the primary goal of the Interaction Approach in second language acquisition (SLA)?

A. To teach grammar rules explicitly

B. To help learners develop implicit knowledge for meaningful communication

C. To develop learners' vocabulary through memorization

D. [Option D is not visible in the screenshot]

Answer: B. To help learners develop implicit knowledge for meaningful communication

Question 23

Which type of corrective feedback is considered input-providing and typically implicit?

A. Elicitations

B. Metalinguistic feedback

C. Clarification requests

D. Recasts

Answer: D. Recasts

Question 24

Which ONE is NOT discussed by SLA researchers?

A. how to learn a second language successfully

B. individual factors that influence second language learning

C. socio-cultural environment in which second language learning takes place

D. mechanism by which second language acquisition takes place

Answer: A. how to learn a second language successfully

Question 25

Match the instructional method with its primary characteristic.

1. Begins with rule explanation, followed by controlled and freer practice
2. Emphasizes comprehension and input processing
3. Involves reconstructing a text to focus on form
4. Directly draws attention to linguistic features
5. Focuses on learners discovering rules inductively

Answer: 1 PPP; 2 Processing instruction; 3 Dictogloss; 4 Explicit instruction; 5 Consciousness-raising tasks

Question 26

Match each method of pronunciation instruction with its theoretical basis.

1. Focus on form instruction — Cognitivism and Communicative Language Teaching
2. Repetition drills — Behaviorist learning and Audiolingual method
3. Explicit instruction — Skill Acquisition Theory
4. [Remaining rows are not visible in the screenshot]

Answer: Visible matches as shown above; the rest cannot be verified from the screenshot.

Question 27

Which classroom practice best reflects the pedagogical application of Sociocultural Theory?

A. Providing only summative assessments without interaction

B. Assigning individual language tasks

C. Assigning silent individual grammar drills

D. Facilitating collaborative tasks where learners scaffold each other's language use

Answer: D. Facilitating collaborative tasks where learners scaffold each other's language use

Question 28

What is the Vygotskian concept that describes the space between what a learner can do independently and what they can do with support?

Answer: ZPD (zone of proximal development)

Question 29

Tick the individual differences that can be impacted by instruction in the classroom.

A. motivation

B. willingness to communicate

C. emotions

D. aptitude

E. working memory

Answer: A, B, C: motivation; willingness to communicate; emotions

Question 30

According to Long's Interaction Hypothesis, what process is central to facilitating L2 acquisition?

A. Negotiation for meaning during communication breakdowns

B. Memorizing vocabulary lists

C. Avoiding errors through mechanical drills

D. Translating sentences between L1 and L2

Answer: A. Negotiation for meaning during communication breakdowns

Question 31

One fact about the process of L2 acquisition is that L2 learners follow a similar developmental route in acquiring a new language.

A. True

B. False

Answer: True

Question 32

Which instructional approach is most effective for teaching pragmatics?

A. Explicit teaching of speech acts

B. Implicit instruction

C. Dictation exercises

D. Silent reading practice

Answer: A. Explicit teaching of speech acts

Question 33

According to Sociocultural Theory, language learning occurs solely through internal cognitive processes without the influence of social interaction.

A. True B. False

Answer: False

Question 34

According to Schmidt's Noticing Hypothesis, what is necessary for second language acquisition?

A. Memorization of grammar rules

B. Avoidance of errors during interaction

C. Repetition of input without attention to form

D. Conscious awareness of linguistic forms

Answer: D. Conscious awareness of linguistic forms

Question 35

What is the process called when learners transform external social interactions into internal cognitive functions?

Answer: internalization

Question 36

Which of the following best describes the difference between prescriptive and descriptive grammar?

A. Prescriptive grammar is based on how people actually speak; descriptive grammar is based on formal rules

B. Prescriptive grammar dictates how language should be used; descriptive grammar reflects actual usage

C. Descriptive grammar outlines how language should be used; prescriptive grammar describes natural usage

Answer: B. Prescriptive grammar dictates how language should be used; descriptive grammar reflects actual usage

Question 37

Match the motivational models with their descriptions.

1. Motivation consists of integrative and instrumental types and is key to L2 achievement
2. Motivation is dynamic and changing over time
3. Self-image and identity drive motivation

Answer: 1 Socioeducational Model; 2 Process-oriented Model; 3 L2 Motivational Self-System

Question 38

Write 150-200 words explaining how knowledge of instructed second language acquisition benefits your current or future teaching of English. Spend around 20 minutes for this question.

Visible student response: "Instructed Second Language Acquisition (SLA) plays an essential role in English teaching by changing the focus from knowledge delivery to process facilitation. The first reason is that SLA knowledge helps in understanding realistic expectations. And the better teachers understand such ideas as Krashen's Monitor Hypothesis, the more they can appreciate that fluency comes through comprehensible input rather than hammered grammar rules. This mitigates teacher frustration and learner anxiety by prioritizing communication over total accuracy. Secondly, it supports sound pedagogical decisions. For example, an understanding of Vygotsky's Zone of Proximal Development (ZPD) means instruction is scaffolded, which offers short term appropriate help as opposed to ... [text cut off in screenshot]"

Answer: Student response shown in screenshot; this is not an official answer key, and the response is incomplete in the image.

Question 39

What distinguishes "focus on form" from "focus on forms" in second language instruction?

A. Focus on forms avoids any attention to language structure

B. Focus on form integrates attention to linguistic items within meaning-focused interaction

C. Focus on form is more explicit than focus on forms

D. Focus on form emphasizes grammar rules exclusively

Answer: B. Focus on form integrates attention to linguistic items within meaning-focused interaction

Question 40

The main goal of input enhancement in focus on form instruction is…

A. To highlight linguistic forms in input to increase noticing

B. To test learners' memory of vocabulary

C. To provide corrective feedback during output

D. To replace authentic communication with drills

Answer: A. To highlight linguistic forms in input to increase noticing

Transcription note: The screenshot for Question 22 does not show option D; Question 26 is only partially visible; Question 38 shows only part of a student response, not a complete official answer. These gaps have not been guessed.